

RID RAS KAWINTSEB

BIOGRAPHY



Ras Kawintseb is a Roots Reggae Messenger rooted in Rastafari, who has dedicated his life to music, cultural expression, and service. Based in Ethiopia, he carries a message of unity and Pan-Afrikan consciousness, using reggae as a powerful vehicle to inspire, educate, and uplift.

In 2023, Ras devoted significant time to service through the Pan African School (DEUG 27), working with young Ethiopians and Sudanese refugee children. Through music, he introduced them to singing, group performance, and the history and spirit of Pan-Afrikanism.

Over the years, Ras Kawintseb has travelled extensively across Ethiopia, performing in cities and regions including Shashemene, Addis Ababa, Nazareth, Dessie, Mekelle, Aksum, Adowa, Adigrat, Jimma, Gambela, Dire Dawa, Arba Minch, Gondar, and Bahir Dar. His mission as a Roots Reggae artist has brought his message to diverse communities across the country. Notable performances include the Ethio-Eritrean Trade Fairs (1997) and a special performance for workers at the Grand Ethiopian Renaissance Dam for the Ethiopian New Year in 2024.

Recent works include the release of his second album "BAREFOOT" (2024), a collaboration with BiniZion, accompanied by a music video for the title track. In 2025, he released the song and video "FIDEL", continuing to expand his musical catalogue.

With his cherished Ethiopian Citizen passport Ras Kawintseb travelled to Djibouti to perform in June 2025 and again in July to Mauritius where he was warmly welcomed by the Rastafari community.

In December 2025, Ras Kawintseb and Aethiopika Reggaestra delivered a powerful Tribute to Peter Tosh concert in Addis Ababa, earning strong appreciation from the audience.

He has also been featured at major reggae events at Meskel Square (1997), the Ethiopian Victory Celebrations for Bob Marley's 60th Birthday (2005), and the Ethiopian Millennium Celebrations (2007).

Ras Kawintseb holds a BA in French Studies from the University of Reading, England.

An accomplished singer and songwriter, he performs on guitar, bass, wooden flute, and harmonica. His influences include his father John E. Harvey, B.B. King, and the Original Wailers – Bob Marley, Peter Tosh, and Bunny Livingstone.

